

Security Audit

Molecula (DeFi)

Table of Contents

Executive Summary	4
Project Context	4
Audit Scope	7
Security Rating	8
Intended Smart Contract Functions	9
Code Quality	11
Audit Resources	11
Dependencies	11
Severity Definitions	12
Status Definitions	13
Audit Findings	14
Centralisation	22
Conclusion	23
Our Methodology	24
Disclaimers	26
About Hashlock	27

CAUTION

THIS DOCUMENT IS A SECURITY AUDIT REPORT AND MAY CONTAIN CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION. THIS INCLUDES IDENTIFIED VULNERABILITIES AND MALICIOUS CODE WHICH COULD BE USED TO COMPROMISE THE PROJECT. THIS DOCUMENT SHOULD ONLY BE FOR INTERNAL USE UNTIL ISSUES ARE RESOLVED. ONCE VULNERABILITIES ARE REMEDIATED, THIS REPORT CAN BE MADE PUBLIC. THE CONTENT OF THIS REPORT IS OWNED BY HASHLOCK PTY LTD FOR USE OF THE CLIENT.

Executive Summary

The Molecula team partnered with Hashlock to conduct a security audit of their smart contracts. Hashlock manually and proactively reviewed the code in order to ensure the project's team and community that the deployed contracts are secure.

Project Context

Molecula is a DeFi application built on the Ethereum and Tron blockchains that allows users to stake USDT and earn yield through its native ecosystem. The platform simplifies user interaction by combining staking and yield farming into a single process, enabling users to maximize returns without needing to choose between the two. Molecula's smart contracts handle the distribution of rewards using mUSD, an internal token pegged to USDT, designed to streamline and optimize the yield process.

Project Name: Molecula

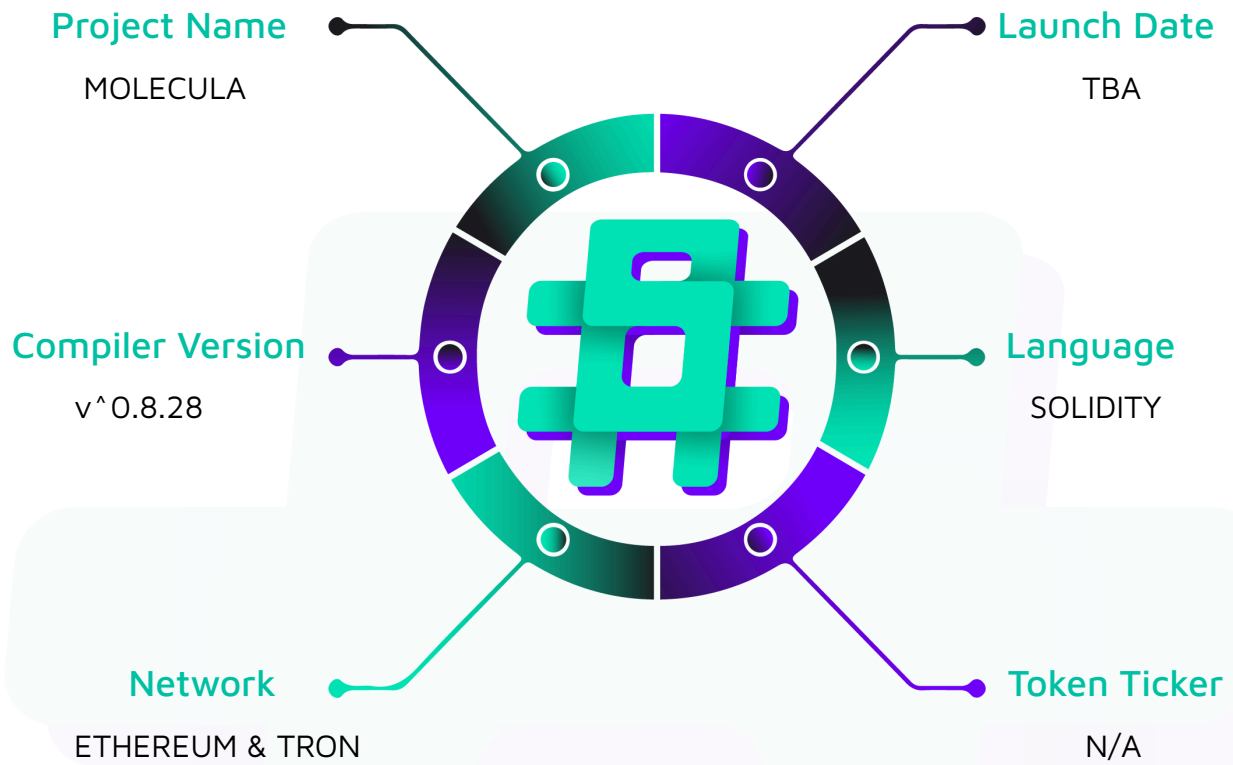
Project Type: Defi, Token, Yield Farming

Compiler Version: ^0.8.28

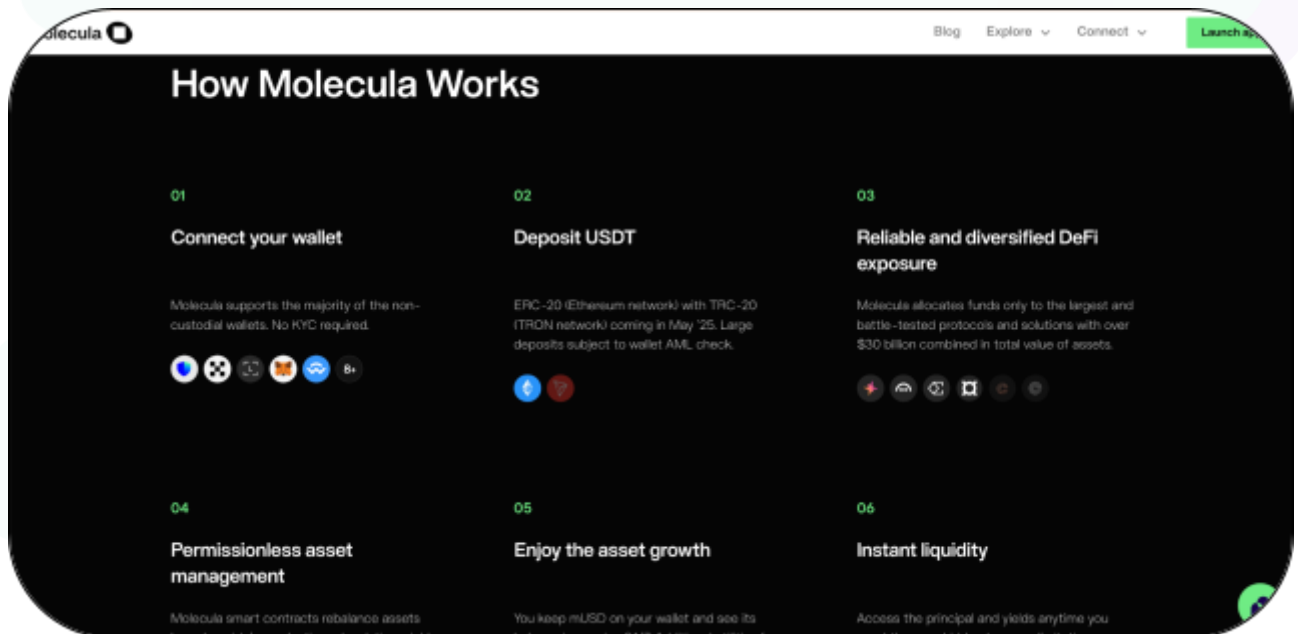
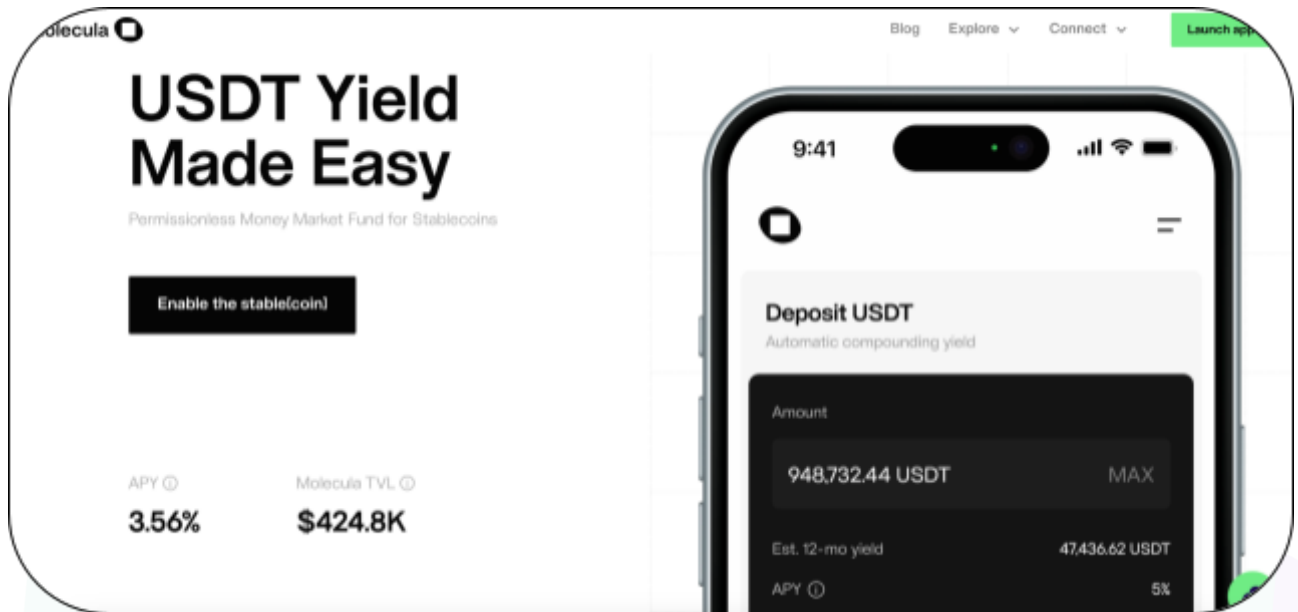
Website: <https://molecula.io>

Logo:



Visualised Context:

Project Visuals:



Audit Scope

We at Hashlock audited the solidity code within the Molecula project, the scope of work included a comprehensive review of the smart contracts listed below. We tested the smart contracts to check for their security and efficiency. These tests were undertaken primarily through manual line-by-line analysis and were supported by software-assisted testing.

Description	Molecula Smart Contracts
Platform	Ethereum & Tron/ Solidity
Audit Date	June, 2025
Contract 1	AgentLZ.sol
Contract 2	AccountantLZ.sol
Contract 3	TronOracle.sol
Contract 4	RebaseTokenTron.sol
Contract 5	RebaseTokenCommon.sol
Contract 6	LZMsgCodec.sol
Contract 7	OptionsLZ.sol
Contract 8	MoleculaPoolTreasuryV2.sol
Contract 9	SupplyManager.sol
Audited GitHub Commit Hash	f20966e0eb858661d67ea2fd7e182ae24de02241
Fix Review GitHub Commit Hash	8110b6b7867781e648135fbe96b9034abf14ad35

Security Rating

After Hashlock's Audit, we found the smart contracts to be **"Secure"**. The contracts all follow simple logic, with correct and detailed ordering. They use a series of interfaces, and the protocol uses a list of Open Zeppelin contracts.



Not Secure

Vulnerable

Secure

Hashlocked

The 'Hashlocked' rating is reserved for projects that ensure ongoing security via bug bounty programs or on chain monitoring technology.

All issues uncovered during automated and manual analysis were meticulously reviewed and applicable vulnerabilities are presented in the [Audit Findings](#) section. The list of audited assets is presented in the [Audit Scope](#) section and the project's contract functionality is presented in the [Intended Smart Contract Functions](#) section.

All vulnerabilities initially identified have now been resolved and acknowledged.

Hashlock found:

3 Low severity vulnerabilities

1 QA

Caution: *Hashlock's audits do not guarantee a project's success or ethics, and are not liable or responsible for security. Always conduct independent research about any project before interacting.*

Intended Smart Contract Functions

Claimed Behaviour	Actual Behaviour
AgentLZ.sol - Handles cross-chain communication via LayerZero - Deposits USDT across chains - Processes redemption requests - Distributes yield to users - Updates oracle data across chains - Manages UsdtOFT transfers	Contract achieves this functionality.
AccountantLZ.sol - Facilitates cross-chain USDT transactions - Confirms deposits - Processes redemption requests - Distributes yield - Updates the oracle data - Manages UsdtOFT transfers	Contract achieves this functionality.
RebaseTokenTron.sol - Implementation of RebaseTokenCommon for Tron - Allows users to deposit, withdraw, and manage shares	Contract achieves this functionality.
RebaseTokenCommon.sol - Tracks pending deposits and withdrawals - Forwards user requests to the accountant for processing across chains - Empowers the accountant to mint extra shares as yield for users	Contract achieves this functionality.

LZMsgCodec.sol - Encodes/decodes messages for cross-chain communication - Defines message types for LayerZero transactions	Contract achieves this functionality.
TronOracle.sol - Provides price and supply data for tokens - Updates the total value and shares data	Contract achieves this functionality.
OptionsLZ.sol - Manages options for LayerZero messaging - Configures gas limits and parameters for cross-chain messages	Contract achieves this functionality.
MoleculaPoolTreasuryV2.sol - Holds actual ERC20/ERC4626 tokens that back mUSD. - Converts and pulls tokens into the treasury - Marks pending redeem amounts - Calls SupplyManager to redeem and tracks tokenToRedeem balances - Supports migration from the old pool	Contract achieves this functionality.
SupplyManager.sol - Keeps track of the shares existing and how much value is deposited - Issue new shares based on deposits - Burns shares on withdrawal and sets aside protocol earnings for later distribution - Allocates earned yield by minting extra shares and updating APY settings	Contract achieves this functionality.

Code Quality

This audit scope involves the smart contracts of the Molecula, as outlined in the Audit Scope section. All contracts, libraries, and interfaces mostly follow standard best practices and to help avoid unnecessary complexity that increases the likelihood of exploitation, however, some refactoring was recommended to optimize security measures.

The code is very well commented on and closely follows best practice nat-spec styling. All comments are correctly aligned with code functionality.

Audit Resources

We were given the Molecula smart contract code in the form of Github access.

As mentioned above, code parts are well commented. The logic is straightforward, and therefore it is easy to quickly comprehend the programming flow as well as the complex code logic. The comments are helpful in providing an understanding of the protocol's overall architecture.

Dependencies

As per our observation, the libraries used in this smart contracts infrastructure are based on well-known industry standard open source projects.

Apart from libraries, its functions are used in external smart contract calls.

Severity Definitions

The severity levels assigned to findings represent a comprehensive evaluation of both their potential impact and the likelihood of occurrence within the system. These categorizations are established based on Hashlock's professional standards and expertise, incorporating both industry best practices and our discretion as security auditors. This ensures a tailored assessment that reflects the specific context and risk profile of each finding.

Significance	Description
High	High-severity vulnerabilities can result in loss of funds, asset loss, access denial, and other critical issues that will result in the direct loss of funds and control by the owners and community.
Medium	Medium-level difficulties should be solved before deployment, but won't result in loss of funds.
Low	Low-level vulnerabilities are areas that lack best practices that may cause small complications in the future.
Gas	Gas Optimisations, issues, and inefficiencies.
QA	Quality Assurance (QA) findings are informational and don't impact functionality. Supports clients improve the clarity, maintainability, or overall structure of the code.

Status Definitions

Each identified security finding is assigned a status that reflects its current stage of remediation or acknowledgment. The status provides clarity on the handling of the issue and ensures transparency in the auditing process. The statuses are as follows:

Significance	Description
Resolved	The identified vulnerability has been fully mitigated either through the implementation of the recommended solution proposed by Hashlock or through an alternative client-provided solution that demonstrably addresses the issue.
Acknowledged	The client has formally recognized the vulnerability but has chosen not to address it due to the high cost or complexity of remediation. This status is acceptable for medium and low-severity findings after internal review and agreement. However, all high-severity findings must be resolved without exception.
Unresolved	The finding remains neither remediated nor formally acknowledged by the client, leaving the vulnerability unaddressed.

Audit Findings

Low

[L-01] AccountantLZ#requestDeposit - The Accounting Is Broken If USDT Implements Fees

Description

USDT has a built-in fee mechanism, and currently, the implemented fee is zero. However, if the issuers decide to implement the fees positively, even for one instance, this would break the accounting with incorrect shares. The system does not check the actual received token amounts after USDT transfers. If USDT implements fee-on-transfer functionality, users will deposit less than the system accounts for, creating value leakage.

Vulnerability Details

In both `AccountantLZ.requestDeposit` and `AgentLZ.redeem`, USDT transfers are handled with naive accounting that assumes full values are transferred:

```
// Transfer USDT from the user to this contract, acting as the Accountant.  
// slither-disable-next-line arbitrary-send-erc20  
USDT.safeTransferFrom(user, address(this), value);
```

AgentLz.sol:

```
// Transfer USDT tokens from the MoleculaPool to the AgentLZ contract.  
// This ensures the contract has enough funds for the cross-chain transfer.  
// slither-disable-next-line arbitrary-send-erc20  
USDT.safeTransferFrom(fromAddress, address(this), totalValue);
```

The code assumes the exact requested amount is transferred, but if USDT implements a fee-on-transfer mechanism, the actual received amount would be less than the requested amount.

No balance checks are performed before and after the transfer, and the system still records the full pre-fee amount in its deposit records

Impact

Protocol receives less USDT than expected; however, the system mints shares based on the pre-fee deposit amount. This creates a value deficit in the protocol - users collectively receive shares representing more USDT than exists in the system.

Recommendation

Implement balance change tracking for all token transfers:

```
// Before transfer
uint256 balanceBefore = USDT.balanceOf(address(this));

// Perform transfer
USDT.safeTransferFrom(user, address(this), value);
// After transfer - get actual received amount
uint256 balanceAfter = USDT.balanceOf(address(this));
uint256 actualAmount = balanceAfter - balanceBefore;

// Use actualAmount instead of value for all subsequent operations
// ...
```

Status

Resolved

[L-02] MoleculePoolTreasuryV2#redeem - An adversary can disrupt a multi-redeem call

Description

The `redeem(uint256[] memory requestIds)` function in `MoleculePoolTreasuryV2` forwards the entire array of request IDs to `SupplyManager.redeem`.

If any one of those IDs has already been consumed, marked as `Confirmed`, the call reverts, and the user's entire batch fails.

An attacker can watch the mempool for a pending batch call, frontrun it by redeeming any single ID from that batch, and thereby block the original caller's entire redemption.

While this potentially allows disruption of a batch redeem if one of the request IDs is processed first, each time the batch will be partially executed. Therefore, the protocol's core redemption logic remains intact, and user funds are not at risk of being blocked from withdrawal.

Vulnerability Details

In `MoleculePoolTreasuryV2.sol`, Lines: 446- 461;

```
function redeem(uint256[] memory requestIds) external payable {
    if (isRedeemPaused) {
        revert ERedeemPaused();
    }

    if (requestIds.length == 0) {
        revert EEmptyArray();
    }

    (address token, uint256 value) = ISupplyManager(SUPPLY_MANAGER).redeem({value:
msg.value}{
        address(this),
        >>> requestIds <<<
    });
}
```

This is handled at the `SupplyManager` side as;

```

function redeem(
    address fromAddress,
    uint256[] memory requestIds
) external payable onlyMolecularPool returns (address token, uint256 redeemedValue) {
    // In the Molecule Pool, we checked that `requestIds` is not empty.
    // Check the status of the first operation.
    >>>    if (redeemRequests[requestIds[0]].status != OperationStatus.Pending) {
        revert EBadOperationStatus(); <<< //@audit point of revert
    }

    // Create an array to store the values of the requests.
    uint256[] memory values = new uint256[](requestIds.length);

    // Initialize the first and total values.
    values[0] = redeemRequests[requestIds[0]].value;
    uint256 totalValue = values[0];
    // Get the Agent associated with the first request.
    address agent = redeemRequests[requestIds[0]].agent;
    // Set the status of the first request to `Confirmed`.
    redeemRequests[requestIds[0]].status = OperationStatus.Confirmed; <<< //@audit
marks the frontrun ID as confirmed

    //..Rest of the function ..//

```

That marks that ID as “Confirmed” in `SupplyManager`, so the original call (which still includes that ID) reverts.

Impact

The redeem process could be disrupted for the number of IDs in the input parameters. However, the attacker sponsors the gas cost for the redeems.

Recommendation

Implementing a try/catch approach for every ID.

Status

Acknowledged

[L-03] MoleculePoolTreasuryV2#_removeToken - One can grief the token removal functionality

Description

The owner's privileged function `_removeToken(address token)` calls the internal `_removeToken`, which requires the treasury's balance of that token to be exactly zero before allowing removal.

An attacker can send a dust amount of any whitelisted token into the treasury just before the owner's transaction, causing `removeToken` to always revert and permanently block cleanup of that token.

Vulnerability Details

In MoleculePoolTreasuryV2.sol, lines 318-337:

```
function _removeToken(address token) internal {
    if (poolMap[token].tokenType == TokenType.None) {
        revert ETokenNotExist();
    }

    >>> uint256 balance = IERC20(token).balanceOf(address(this));
    if (balance > 0) {
        revert ENotZeroBalanceOfRemovedToken();
    }
    if (poolMap[token].valueToRedeem > 0) {
        revert ENotZeroValueToRedeemOfRemovedToken();
    }

    //.. Rest of the function .. //
```

Impact

The owner then cannot ever remove that token from the pool, blocking pool cleanup, upgrades, or deprecation of stale tokens.

Recommendation

Add an internal "sweep" function that allows the owner to withdraw ERC20 tokens from the treasury, inlined in the `_removeToken` function.

Status

Resolved



QA

[Q-01] RebaseERC20#approve - Unstable Allowances Create Unpredictable transferFrom Behavior During Price Fluctuations

Description

The ``allowance`` and ``transferFrom`` functions in `RebaseERC20.sol` create inconsistent behavior where approved spending amounts vary with share price changes, potentially causing operator transactions to unexpectedly fail.

Vulnerability Details

In `RebaseERC20.sol`, lines 162-169:

```
function allowance(
    address owner,
    address spender
) public view override returns (uint256 amount) {
    uint256 allow = _allowances[owner][spender];
    // Note: `type(uint256).max` means an infinite allowance.
    return allow == type(uint256).max ? allow : convertToAssets(allow);
}
```

And the corresponding ``transferFrom`` implementation (lines 192-202):

```
function transferFrom(
    address from,
    address to,
    uint256 value
) public override returns (bool result) {
    address spender = _msgSender();
    uint256 shares = convertToShares(value);
    _spendAllowance(from, spender, shares);
    _transfer(from, to, shares);
    return true;
}
```

The issue arises because:

Allowances are stored internally as shares (in ``_allowances``) and are exposed to users as asset values (via ``convertToAssets``).

When the share price fluctuations occur, the asset value representation changes. This creates unpredictable behavior for operators and integrating contracts.

For example:

A user approves 100 USDT for an operator.

Internally, this is stored as X shares based on the current conversion rate.

After price fluctuations due to deposits, withdrawals, or yield distribution, that same X shares might represent 105 USDT or 95 USDT.

When displayed via ``allowance()``, the approval amount appears to have changed.

When the share price increases, the operation succeeds, but some shares remain as "unspent approval". This is problematic for contracts that expect exact approvals to be consumed.

When the share price decreases, the operation fails with "insufficient allowance".

This breaks integrations expecting to transfer a specific USDT amount.

Both scenarios create unpredictable behavior that's especially problematic for smart contracts that integrate with Molecula and depend on consistent allowance behavior.

Impact

Operators may find their authorized operations fail unpredictably as share prices fluctuate, and users will observe their approvals changing value without any action on their part.

Recommendation

Store allowances in asset values and convert to shares only during the transfer operation.

Status

Acknowledged

Centralisation

The Molecula protocol prioritizes security and utility while maintaining a clear commitment to progressive decentralization. Although certain owner-executable functions are currently retained by the core team to ensure operational stability and safeguard critical protocol components, a structured transition to DAO governance is planned. This reflects the project's strategic direction toward distributing control and aligning with decentralized governance standards over time.



Centralised

Decentralised

Conclusion

After Hashlock's analysis, the Molecula project seems to have a sound and well-tested code base, now that our vulnerability findings have been resolved and acknowledged. Overall, most of the code is correctly ordered and follows industry best practices. The code is well commented on as well. To the best of our ability, Hashlock is not able to identify any further vulnerabilities.

Our Methodology

Hashlock strives to maintain a transparent working process and to make our audits a collaborative effort. The objective of our security audits is to improve the quality of systems and upcoming projects we review and to aim for sufficient remediation to help protect users and project leaders. Below is the methodology we use in our security audit process.

Manual Code Review:

In manually analysing all of the code, we seek to find any potential issues with code logic, error handling, protocol and header parsing, cryptographic errors, and random number generators. We also watch for areas where more defensive programming could reduce the risk of future mistakes and speed up future audits. Although our primary focus is on the in-scope code, we examine dependency code and behaviour when it is relevant to a particular line of investigation.

Vulnerability Analysis:

Our methodologies include manual code analysis, user interface interaction, and white box penetration testing. We consider the project's website, specifications, and whitepaper (if available) to attain a high-level understanding of what functionality the smart contract under review contains. We then communicate with the developers and founders to gain insight into their vision for the project. We install and deploy the relevant software, exploring the user interactions and roles. While we do this, we brainstorm threat models and attack surfaces. We read design documentation, review other audit results, search for similar projects, examine source code dependencies, skim open issue tickets, and generally investigate details other than the implementation.

Documenting Results:

We undergo a robust, transparent process for analysing potential security vulnerabilities and seeing them through to successful remediation. When a potential issue is discovered, we immediately create an issue entry for it in this document, even though we have not yet verified the feasibility and impact of the issue. This process is vast because we document our suspicions early even if they are later shown to not represent exploitable vulnerabilities. We generally follow a process of first documenting the suspicion with unresolved questions, and then confirming the issue through code analysis, live experimentation, or automated tests. Code analysis is the most tentative, and we strive to provide test code, log captures, or screenshots demonstrating our confirmation. After this, we analyse the feasibility of an attack in a live system.

Suggested Solutions:

We search for immediate mitigations that live deployments can take and finally, we suggest the requirements for remediation engineering for future releases. The mitigation and remediation recommendations should be scrutinised by the developers and deployment engineers, and successful mitigation and remediation is an ongoing collaborative process after we deliver our report, and before the contract details are made public.

Disclaimers

Hashlock's Disclaimer

Hashlock's team has analysed these smart contracts in accordance with the best industry practices at the date of this report, in relation to: cybersecurity vulnerabilities and issues in the smart contract source code, the details of which are disclosed in this report, (Source Code); the Source Code compilation, deployment, and functionality (performing the intended functions).

Due to the fact that the total number of test cases is unlimited, the audit makes no statements or warranties on the security of the code. It also cannot be considered as a sufficient assessment regarding the utility and safety of the code, bug-free status, or any other statements of the contract. While we have done our best in conducting the analysis and producing this report, it is important to note that you should not rely on this report only. We also suggest conducting a bug bounty program to confirm the high level of security of this smart contract.

Hashlock is not responsible for the safety of any funds and is not in any way liable for the security of the project.

Technical Disclaimer

Smart contracts are deployed and executed on a blockchain platform. The platform, its programming language, and other software related to the smart contract can have their own vulnerabilities that can lead to attacks. Thus, the audit can't guarantee the explicit security of the audited smart contracts.

About Hashlock

Hashlock is an Australian-based company aiming to help facilitate the successful widespread adoption of distributed ledger technology. Our key services all have a focus on security, as well as projects that focus on streamlined adoption in the business sector.

Hashlock is excited to continue to grow its partnerships with developers and other web3-oriented companies to collaborate on secure innovation, helping businesses and decentralised entities alike.

Website: hashlock.com.au

Contact: info@hashlock.com.au



#hashlock.